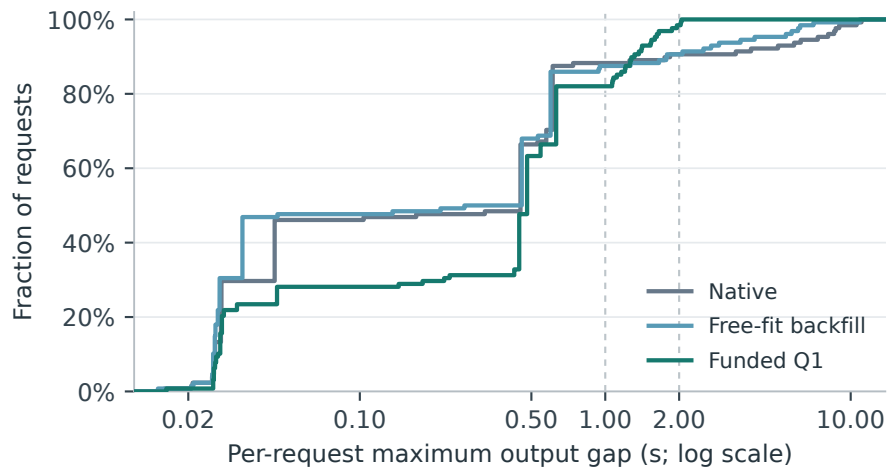


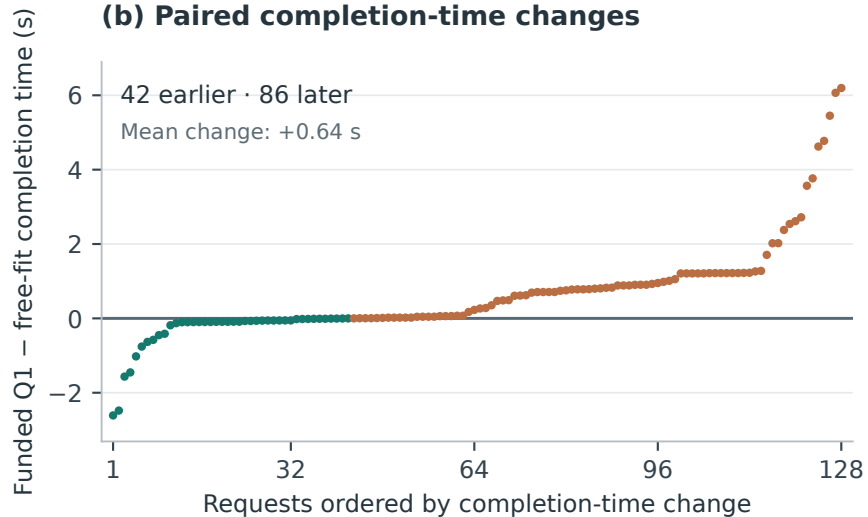
Tail gains and request-level costs

Base-model article workload · all 128 requests per arm · one exploratory run per arm · RTX 5090

(a) Full-cohort maximum-gap ECDF



(b) Paired completion-time changes



Funded Q1 vs free-fit: maximum gap worsens for 89/128; gap >1 s: 16 → 23; gap >2 s: 12 → 2.

Paired by request ID with identical arrivals; output trajectories differ. These are descriptive changes, not equal-work causal effects.

No confidence intervals. Requests and action events are not independent run replicates; no pooling across machines.